

3, Social Revolution is a Long-Term Enterprise

I am profoundly dismissive of the anti-intellectual revolutionary propaganda espoused by the Soviet Union and its satellite states. The Bolsheviks invariably proclaimed that revolution was merely about plunging headlong into massive endeavors and charging forward blindly under the command of a "brilliant leader," thereby *"traversing in a mere few decades the path that took the West centuries to complete."*

Now I know these are entirely fabrications. **Early modernization and modernization** (近现代化) are not catalyzed overnight. Or rather, since the dawn of humanity, absolutely no monumental transformation could be achieved in the short term. Without exception, they require prolonged **"social preparation"** (社会准备)—meaning the entire society must cultivate the potential to birth, welcome, and sustain the transformation.

The brief decades of "revolution" as perceived by the Chinese were nothing more than the bugle of victory blown *after* all preconditions were suitably met; by that stage, the pacification of the realm was merely a matter of logical progression.

Chinese people in the past invariably sighed, questioning why Japan reacted so swiftly and effectively when faced with Western encroachment, while the Chinese Empire appeared so sluggish and obtuse.

Today, the answer is glaringly obvious. True, Japan did not even take 100 years to go from the Meiji Restoration to democratization post-World War II, but who remembers how much time and effort was expended for this single century?

Even from the most conservative standpoint, shortly after the establishment of the Kamakura Shogunate at the turn of the 12th and 13th centuries, Japan's social development had already fundamentally parted ways with China's. This means that by the onset of the Meiji Restoration, although Japanese society could not have subjectively aimed to "achieve early modernization," it had, in fact, through **feudalization** (封建化), struggled for nearly seven centuries to prepare itself to embrace modern civilization.

Anyone possessing fundamental reasoning capacity can discern that before the West used armed force to compel China and Japan to open their doors, these two countries were already starkly different.

Japan's societal emphasis on contracts and laws, its highly developed civil culture and civil spirit, a literacy rate that left the rest of Asia in the dust, its rich and diverse grassroots public activities and travel, its exceptional financial practices, and the organized, disciplined, and methodical active resistance of its people—how many of these countless characteristics could be found in late Qing society? Yet, they were the very bedrock of modernization.

People recognized long ago that the future trajectory of a society or a state depends on where it originally came from. However, facts prove that the history exerting a decisive influence on the present is far more ancient than people initially anticipated. It is absolutely not just the past ten, twenty, or even a hundred years that determine the future.

Based on my observations, I incline to believe that the timeframe influencing a society's trajectory spans at least an entire historical stage tracing backward from the current node. This implies that any social revolution is inevitably a long-term enterprise.

From the perspective of someone who is still a student, I term this the "**Examination Principle**" (考试原理). The abrupt, radical leap of any society from one social stage to the next resembles taking an examination.

The duration of the exam is very brief. Take China's *Gaokao* (National College Entrance Examination) for example; the combined time for all subjects does not even total 24 hours. But how many days and nights does an individual sacrifice for those brief hours? If a person completely neglects their studies during regular times, or does not even know what they ought to learn—to the point that everything they absorb is distorted and erroneous—on what grounds can they possibly cope with any examination?

This is precisely why I consider the ideology of the Soviet Bolsheviks to be akin to a cult (邪教). It deceives those students who routinely engage in delinquency, promising them a secret method to pass the exam. But the reality is, while one might occasionally cheat undetected in a real-world exam, who can possibly cheat the evolutionary process of human history?

The Bolsheviks proclaimed: *"Submit entirely to my leadership, contribute your money, your labor, and even your lives. Do not associate with those 'good students'—the only reason they perform well is by exploiting you 'bad students.' Just follow me, shout fanatical slogans, and you will pass the exam."*

Such behavior is virtually indistinguishable from murder for profit. Ultimately, it only benefits the swindlers and thieves, rendering the students—who were already entirely unprepared for the exam—even more devoid of hope. If previously, by following the good students to cram for the final month, they might have at least scraped into an undergraduate program, now they have no chance of even completing an associate degree.

(Of course, I am not engaging in any academic discrimination here. It is simply that in the social environment where I live, no analogy is more vivid than the Gaokao. A normal society should logically be one where all people are equal, regardless of academic background, race, or gender.)

However, herein lies the profound tragedy. Since every decisive social transformation requires long-term social preparation, the countries that are the most entirely unprepared or have already strayed onto a derailed path are the very ones most susceptible to embracing such malicious agitation. They delude themselves into believing they have found a path to survival, completely oblivious to the fact that this path will only plunge the nation and its people into even more horrific catastrophes.

This is a colossal tragedy in human society.

3, 社会革命是长期事业

我更加对苏联及其仆从国那反智的革命宣传嗤之以鼻，布尔什维克总是宣称革命就是大干特干，在英明领袖指挥下埋头冲锋，“在短短几十年时间走完西方上百年的道路”。现在我知道这都是谎言，近现代化的革命不是一朝一夕促成，或者说，人类诞生以来所有伟大的变革都不是短期内就可以实现的，无一例外需要长时间的“社会准备”，也就是整个社会具备去诞生，迎接和继续变革的可能性，而中国人认识中那短短几十年的“革命”，不过是一切条件合适后吹起的胜利号角，到这个阶段天下平定已经是顺理成章的事了。中国人过去总是感慨，为什么日本在面临西方逼近时如此快和有效地做出了反应，而中华帝国却如此迟缓和愚笨。如今答案是明显的，诚然日本从明治维新到战败之后民主化也没有用100年，但是有谁能记起为了这一个世纪付出了多长时间的 effort？即使从最保守的角度来看，在12世纪末13世纪初镰仓幕府建立之后一段时间，日本的社会发展就已经与中国完全分道扬镳了，这也意味着到

明治维新开始为止，日本社会虽然不可能在主观上“为了近现代化如何如何”，但的确通过封建化在事实上“为了迎接现代文明”所奋斗了近七个世纪之久。

任何人即使用一点脑子都能看出来在西方用武力迫使中国和日本打开国门之前，这两个国家已经截然不同，日本社会中对于契约、法律的重视，发达的市民文化和市民精神，在亚洲一骑绝尘的识字率，丰富多彩的民间活动和旅行，出色的金融实践，人民有组织纪律和章法的积极抗争，这些数不清的特征有几个在晚清社会能见到？但他们的确是现代化的基石。人们在很久以前就已经清晰地认识到，一个社会，一个国家未来走向何方取决于当初来自何处，然而事实证明对现在所产生决定性影响的历史比人们一开始所预料的更为久远。绝不只是过去十年二十年甚至百年就能决定未来如何，经过我的观察，我倾向于对于社会走向产生影响的时间段至少是从当前节点向前反推的一整个历史阶段，这意味着任何社会革命都必然是一项长期的事业。

从仍然是一个学生的角度我称之为“考试原理”，任何社会从一个社会阶段跃进下一个社会阶段的短促激变都如同一次考试。考试的时间很短，就拿中国的高考来说所有科目加起来也没有 24 个小时长，但是每一个人为了这短短不到一天的时间付出了多少个日日夜夜？如果一个人平时完全不学习，甚至不知道自己应该学什么以至于学到的全是歪门邪道，那么他凭什么能够应付任何考试呢？这也是为什么我认为苏联布尔什维克的意识形态是一种邪教，他欺骗那些平日里面天天做坏事的学生自己有一个秘法能够让他们都通过考试，但事实是现实中的考试尚且可能作弊不被发现，但是在人类发展的进程中有谁能够作弊呢？布尔什维克声称你们都服从我的领导，你们出钱出力乃至出命，不要跟那些“好学生”接触，“好学生”能学好都是靠剥削你们这些坏学生才能学好，只要跟着我，喊着打鸡血的口号考试就通过了。这种行为跟谋财害命没有一点区别，它最终只便宜了骗子和窃贼，使得本来就没有对考试有任何准备的学生更加了无希望，如果说之前跟着学得好的学生突击最后一个月至少能上个本科，那么现在连读个大专都没戏了。当然，这里我不是进行任何学历歧视，只是在我所生活的社会环境里没有哪个例子比高考更为生动形象，一个正常的社会理应是不分学历、种族、性别，而人人平等的。然而悲剧的地方也就在这里，既然每一场决定性的社会变革都需要长期的社会准备，那么对于那些越是完全准备不足或者已经走上歧路的国家来说，他们就越容易接受这样邪恶的鼓动，自以为真的找了一条活路，完全没有意识到这条道路只会让国家和人民陷入更为惨烈的灾难，这是人类社会中极大的悲剧。